Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Sunday, 18 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Light rain	Overcast	Partly cloudy	Mostly clear
14° 8°	12° 6°	13° 5°	11° 3°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **Scotland's First Minister John Swinney has taken a swipe at Prime Minister Andy Burnham, saying Scotland is 'not like Manchester'.**
Speaking at the SNP conference, Mr Swinney also announced plans to bring Scotland's bus network back under public control. It marks a clear divergence from central government policy.
POLITICS · UK

2 **A mother whose two young sons were killed by their father is hoping a new law will be their legacy.**
Jack and Paul, aged 12 and 9, died during a contact visit despite their mother's concerns. She's now campaigning for changes to the law to protect other children.
LAW · UK

3 **New documents reveal police feared Prince Andrew would try to delay a search of his home by claiming it belonged to the King.**
The legal records shed light on why officers wanted to search the royal's property. They detail the specific items police were looking for at the time.
ROYALS · UK

4 **Reports of 'mystery drones' over the UK and troops heading to Poland for war games are making headlines this morning.**
The Daily Telegraph leads with claims that RAF jets had two close encounters with unidentified drones. Other papers focus on military exercises in Eastern Europe.
DEFENCE · UK

5 **More than a million people who have never smoked are now regularly vaping, according to new figures.**
The Office for National Statistics data shows a significant rise in non-smokers taking up e-cigarettes. This trend raises new public health questions.
HEALTH · UK

02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **If you're still planning your Halloween outfit, a new list reveals the most popular costumes this year.**

Among the top choices are 'Freaky Nikki', Dolly Parton, and whimsical gargoyle-inspired looks. It seems people are getting creative with their spooky attire.

ON AIR — What's the best Halloween costume you've ever worn or seen?

CULTURE · OCTOBER

2 **Dame Judi Dench has joined the campaign to keep The Archers in Birmingham, as plans emerge to move production.**

The acclaimed actress is backing the cast, who say moving the beloved radio drama would be like 'Corrie leaving the North West'. The show has been made in Birmingham since 1950.

ON AIR — Do you think it's important for shows like The Archers to stay connected to their original locations?

TV & RADIO · ONGOING

3 **Welsh singer Jamie Miller says a collaboration with the star of 'Off Campus' gave him 'chills'.**

His viral hit, 'Babydoll', narrowly missed out on the UK number one spot. Jamie hopes he's 'doing Wales proud' with his music.

ON AIR — Who would be your dream musical collaboration?

MUSIC · NEW

4 **Marvel fans are getting ready to meet a new Welsh superhero, complete with a Cardiff accent!**

Lauren Morais is set to play villain Lisa Molinari in the upcoming Disney+ series 'VisionQuest'. It's a big moment for Welsh representation in the Marvel universe.

ON AIR — Which regional accent would you love to hear on a superhero?

TV & FILM · UPCOMING

5 **The new 'Street Fighter' movie is being hailed as 'made by fans for fans', but can it win over the critics?**

Cast members Noah Centineo and Andrew Koji have been discussing the latest video game adaptation. It's always a challenge to bring popular games to the big screen.

ON AIR — What's your favourite video game adaptation, or the one you'd love to see made?

FILM · NEW

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **England's incredible 41-match unbeaten run has come to an end, with Canada securing a dramatic 24-21 victory.**

Shoshanah Seumanutafa scored a late try in Toronto to hand Canada the thrilling win. It's a shock result for the dominant England side.

ON AIR — After such a long winning streak, how do you think this loss will affect the team going forward?

RUGBY · INTERNATIONAL

2 **Britain's Anna Morris has completed a hat-trick of gold medals at the Track Cycling World Championships in Shanghai.**

Morris's impressive performance caps a fantastic championships for the British team. She's been a standout star on the track.

ON AIR — What's the most impressive individual sporting achievement you've seen recently?

CYCLING · INTERNATIONAL

3 **Billy Loughnane, at just 20 years old, has become the youngest champion jockey since 1923!**

Loughnane collected his trophy at Ascot, marking a historic achievement in British racing. It's an incredible start to his career.

ON AIR — Who's a young talent in sport that you're really excited about right now?

HORSE RACING · UK

4 **England's women's rugby league team crushed World Cup debutants Wales with a dominant 70-6 victory.**

England scored seven tries before the break and 13 in total in their Group A opening game in Perth, Australia. It was a comprehensive display.

ON AIR — How important is it to see such strong performances from our women's sports teams on the world stage?

RUGBY LEAGUE · INTERNATIONAL

5 **Eugenio Chacarra has extended his lead at the DP World India Championship, but Rory McIlroy has lost ground.**

Play was halted in the third round due to darkness, with McIlroy struggling to keep pace. It sets up an intriguing final day.

ON AIR — What's your favourite part about watching a golf tournament – the drama, the skill, or the scenery?

GOLF · INTERNATIONAL

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1 **A new study suggests that the sound of rain on a windowpane is particularly soothing for pets.**
Researchers observed that dogs and cats often settle down more quickly for a nap when gentle rainfall can be heard. It seems to have a calming effect on our furry friends!

2 **The simple act of 'doodling' during meetings is being hailed as a creativity booster.**
Experts say that allowing your mind to wander with a pen and paper can actually help you focus better on complex discussions and even spark new ideas. So, doodle away!

3 **More people are finding quiet enjoyment in the art of 'identifying clouds'.**
From fluffy cumulus to wispy cirrus, learning the different cloud formations is becoming a mindful hobby, connecting people to the natural world above. Look up!

4 **The humble 'teacup' is seeing a resurgence in popularity, with many seeking out unique and vintage designs.**
It's not just for tea anymore; these beautiful vessels are being used for everything from tiny plant pots to decorative desk tidies, adding a touch of elegance to everyday life.

5 **Discovering a 'perfectly aligned queue' at the supermarket checkout is bringing small moments of joy to shoppers.**
There's something deeply satisfying about a queue that moves swiftly and efficiently, almost like a little win in the daily grind. We've all been there!

6 **The surprising charm of 'collecting interesting pebbles' is washing up on our shores.**
People are finding delight in the unique shapes, colours, and textures of stones found on beaches and riverbanks, turning them into lovely decorative pieces for their homes.

7 **A recent trend highlights the simple pleasure of 'rewatching favourite childhood films'.**
There's a wonderful comfort in revisiting those familiar stories and characters, bringing a warm wave of nostalgia and often a fresh perspective as an adult.

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05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to quietly 'doing' what when trying to decide if a new book will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?**

ANSWER: THEY GIVE IT A GOOD SNIFF! APPARENTLY, THE SMELL OF PAPER AND INK IS A HUGE PART OF THE READING EXPERIENCE.

Q **Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd ritual' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a new pack of biscuits, especially if they're a fancy, artisan one. What is it?**

ANSWER: THEY CAREFULLY ARRANGE THEM INTO A PERFECT STACK OR PATTERN ON A PLATE BEFORE EATING THE FIRST ONE! PRESENTATION IS KEY, EVEN FOR BISCUITS.

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes you pick up a 'random, everyday object' – maybe an old ticket stub, a foreign coin, or a pressed flower – and it just instantly sparks a memory or a story?**
  What's an unexpected everyday item that has a surprising story or memory attached to it for you? Give us a call and share its tale!

- **There's something wonderfully satisfying about a 'small household task' that, once completed, just makes everything feel a bit more organised and lovely.**
  Which small, often overlooked, household chore gives you the most unexpected satisfaction once it's done? Maybe it's cleaning the microwave or polishing the taps!

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** A group of owls is called a parliament.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Baby puffins are called pufflings, and they leave their nests by rolling down cliffs into the sea.

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06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£50 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£50 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The inventor of the Pringle, Fredric Baur, requested to be buried in one of the iconic Pringle cans, and his wish was granted.
- The average person walks the equivalent of five times around the world in their lifetime.
- Butterflies taste with their feet.
- The Great Wall of China is not visible from space with the naked eye.
- Octopuses have three hearts.
- A cloud can weigh more than a million pounds.
- The shortest complete sentence in the English language is 'I am'.
- The 'king of fruits', Durian, is banned on public transport in some Asian countries due to its strong smell.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES SUN 18 OCT 2026

On this day

Day 291 of the year, 74 days left in 2026. Today Alaska Day (Alaska, United States); Christian feast day: Asclepiades of Antioch; Christian feast day: Isaac Jogues; Christian feast day: Luke the Evangelist. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1968 — Rhod Gilbert, Welsh comedian
- 1992 — Barry Keoghan, Irish actor
- 1982 — Mark Sampson, Welsh footballer and manager
- 1940 — Cynthia Weil, American songwriter (died 2023)
- 1979 — Ne-Yo, American singer, songwriter, record producer, dancer, and actor
- 1991 — Tyler Posey, American actor and musician
- 1987 — Zac Efron, American actor and singer
- 1951 — Pam Dawber, American actress and producer

THE DAY TODAY

- 2019 — Riots in Chile's capital Santiago escalate into open battles, with attacks reported at nearly all of the city's 164 Metro stations. President Sebastián Piñera later announces a 15-day state of emergency in the capital.
- 1929 — The Judicial Committee of the Privy Council overrules the Supreme Court of Canada in Edwards v. Canada when it declares that women are considered "Persons" under Canadian law.
- 1977 — German Autumn: A set of events revolving around the kidnapping of Hanns Martin Schleyer and the hijacking of a Lufthansa flight by the Red Army Faction (RAF) comes to an end when Schleyer is murdered and various RAF members allegedly commit suicide.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1944 — World War II: The state funeral of Field Marshal Erwin Rommel takes place in Ulm, Germany.
- 1979 — The Federal Communications Commission (FCC) begins allowing people to have home satellite earth stations without a federal government license.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1887 — Johannes Brahms conducts the premiere of his Double Concerto, composed for violinist Joseph Joachim and cellist Robert Hausmann.

- 1921 — The Crimean Autonomous Soviet Socialist Republic is formed as part of the Russian Soviet Federative Socialist Republic.
- 1989 — The Space Shuttle Atlantis launches on STS-34 to deploy the Jupiter-bound Galileo space probe.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES MON 19 OCT 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 292 of the year, 73 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Aaron (Coptic Orthodox Church of Alexandria); Christian feast day: Blessed Agnes of Jesus; Christian feast day: Aquilinus of Évreux; Christian feast day: Desiderius (Didier) of Auxerre. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1962 — Tracy Chevalier, American-English author
- 1941 — Simon Ward, English actor (died 2012)
- 1968 — Rodney Carrington, American comedian, actor, and singer
- 1977 — Jason Reitman, Canadian-American director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1945 — Jeannie C. Riley, American singer
- 1957 — Karl Wallinger, Welsh singer-songwriter, keyboard player, and producer (died 2024)
- 1951 — Annie Golden, American actress and singer
- 1945 — Gloria Jones, American singer-songwriter

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1987 — Black Monday: The Dow Jones Industrial Average falls by 22%, 508 points.
- 1950 — China defeats the Tibetan Army at Chambo.
- 2005 — Hurricane Wilma becomes the most intense Atlantic hurricane on record with a minimum pressure of 882 mb.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1955 — The General Assembly of the European Broadcasting Union approves the staging of the first Eurovision Song Contest.
- 2025 — Pieces of the French Crown Jewels are successfully stolen during a heist on the Louvre Museum in Paris..

10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 · PREVIEW

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

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